

KYLE GAARDER

Product Manager | Housing Innovation | Experimentation

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SUMMARY

Product-minded housing operator who has designed, tested, and iterated on residential products. I bring hands-on experience in the housing industry - launching a coliving product from zero, running pricing experiments, and building retention systems. My approach combines deep housing knowledge with rapid product experimentation and data-driven decision making.

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

- 📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX
- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching
 - 100% occupancy before lease start
 - A/B tested dynamic pricing and stay-length diversification, driving
 - 48% annual revenue increase
 - Maintained 94% occupancy for 19 months through product
 - iteration and resident experience design
 - Built onboarding, engagement, and retention systems supporting
 - long-term resident satisfaction
 - Ran 48 community programs, 4 masterminds, and 6 work-trade
 - initiatives driving engagement

- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY
- through housing ops optimization

- Facilitated smooth acquisition transition to Macro House while
- maintaining resident continuity

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

- 📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR
- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots
 - outreach and validation
 - Conducted 48 customer interviews to guide housing
 - product-market fit and positioning
 - Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an
 - investor-backed pilot program
 - Led housing product development across strategy, ops, and
 - concept validation

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

- 📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA
- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
 - Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
 - Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
 - Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
 - Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 💎

Housing Product from Zero
Designed and launched residential product from concept to full occupancy in 2 weeks
- 💎

48% Revenue via Experiments
A/B tested pricing and engagement models driving 48% annual revenue growth
- 💎

94% Occupancy for 19 Months
Product-driven retention sustained 94% occupancy for 19 months in emerging market
- 💎

Investor Pilot Secured
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new housing concept across 5 states
- 💎

Demand Pipeline Built
Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

Housing Product Strategy

Rapid Experimentation

Pricing & Revenue Models

Resident Experience Design

Customer Research Interviews

Data-Driven Decisions A/B Tests

Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

Bachelors in Science, Biology

Virginia Tech

📅 08/2010 - 05/2014

📍 Virginia, USA

- Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish

GPA

3.5 / 4.0